



Why We Aren't Using Self-Driving Cars Yet

The term 'self-driving cars' or 'autonomous vehicles' have been making rounds in the industry for quite some time now. We have even seen a few of them in action on the roads. It is almost a consensus that self-driving cars are the future of the automobile industry. Then why is it taking so long for this future to arrive? In this article, we discuss the need for self-driving car, the current predicaments that it faces, and what the future holds for this amazing AI-powered technology

Mir H.S. Quadri

The one thing that I have missed this past year, thanks to the pandemic, is driving a car. I know it's a bit of an unpopular opinion, but you have to admit, driving a car with some music is soothing. I would go as far as to say it is borderline therapeutic. Not to say I haven't driven at all. I take my car out every now and then to run errands, but my time behind the wheel has significantly reduced. Now you might say that's a good thing. And you wouldn't be wrong. Time spent not driving is time that could be used more productively on other things. It helps the earth greatly with

less CO₂ emissions. And if you are in India, then you get to avoid all the harmful side effects caused by the incessant pollution on the streets.

But all the reasons mentioned above pale in comparison to the primary reason why driving a car is not good for you, that is, the risk of meeting with an accident. This is the major motivating factor behind the development of autonomous vehicle technology. Across the globe, roughly 1.35 million people die each year as a direct cause of traffic accidents. And that's besides the injuries, amputations, mental and physical

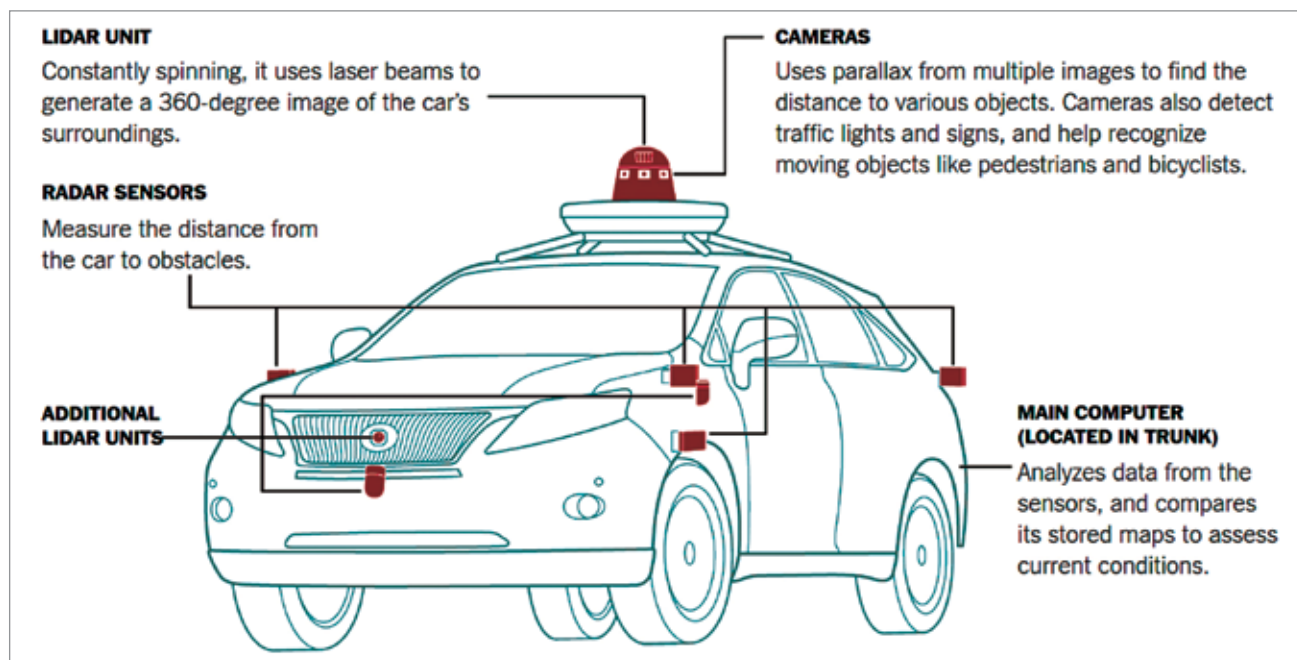


Fig. 1: Components of a self-driving car (Courtesy: The New York Times)